Urban Hive Co.

Urban Hive Co. wants to put beehives on the flat roofs of office buildings and sell the honey under a local label. The idea sounds like a gimmick until you look at the unit economics. One hive yields about 25 kilograms in a good season, and rooftop honey in our city retails at roughly 1,400 rupees per kilogram because buyers like the story. A hive costs 9,000 rupees to set up, so payback is under a season if the colony survives. That last condition is the catch. Heat on bare concrete roofs can kill a colony in May, so every site needs shade netting and a water tray, which adds about 2,500 rupees. We also learned that building managers care less about honey than about liability; the first three pitches failed until we offered insurance cover and a sting-free zone around the stairwell. Our current plan is twelve rooftops by March, with a part-time beekeeper visiting each fortnight. The risk I worry about most is not the bees but the permits: two municipal wards still treat hives as livestock. If that is not resolved by January, we will move the pilot to private campuses where the rules are simpler and the answer is faster.